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INDIA, THE UNITED STATES, AND THE INDO-PACIFIC REGION

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Introduction

This chapter explores India's response to the Indian Ocean Region and the Asia-Pacific region merging into one larger Indo-Pacific region. Growing interconnectivity through trade, investments, and infrastructure now links these two regions closer together. Moreover, the concept of an Indo-Pacific region is driven equally by China increasing its interests in the Indian Ocean Region, India increasing its attention to the Pacific, and the United States developing a new outlook on Asia through an Indo-Pacific Strategy, including by transforming its former military Pacific Command (USPACOM) into a new Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM). In other words, the emergence of the new Indo-Pacific region is the result of increased interconnectivity and of the great powers viewing it as one strategic theatre.

Acknowledging that its strategic outlook in the Indo-Pacific is currently shaped by China's rise and the changing co-relation of the great powers, India will naturally seek